

Network Change Readiness Checklist

Rupesh Kumar · A pre-cutover checklist for LAN/WAN/WLAN, firewall and data-centre changes

1. Scope & approvals

- ☐ Change record raised with clear scope, devices/sites in scope and business justification
- ☐ Change approved by CAB / change authority; maintenance window confirmed with business
- ☐ Stakeholders and service owners notified; communication plan agreed

2. Design & validation

- ☐ Low-level design / config reviewed and peer-checked
- ☐ Configuration tested in lab or on a representative pilot device
- ☐ Dependencies identified: circuits, firewall rules, DNS/DHCP, authentication, monitoring
- ☐ IP addressing, VLANs and routing changes documented

3. Pre-change

- ☐ Current configs backed up and stored outside the device
- ☐ Baseline captured: interface status, routing tables, key application tests
- ☐ Console / out-of-band access confirmed for every device
- ☐ Spares and vendor support (TAC) availability confirmed
- ☐ Monitoring alerts suppressed for the window (and re-enable step scheduled)

4. Rollback

- ☐ Rollback steps written and tested, with time required to roll back
- ☐ Go / no-go decision points and rollback trigger criteria agreed
- ☐ Named decision-maker available throughout the window

5. Execution & validation

- ☐ Runbook followed step by step with timestamps
- ☐ Post-change checks completed against the baseline
- ☐ Application owners / users confirm service (UAT) before closure

6. Closure

- ☐ Monitoring re-enabled; documentation and CMDB updated
- ☐ Hypercare period and contact defined
- ☐ Lessons learned captured for the next wave

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